

FROM SERVICE TO PRODUCT: AN INTRODUCTION

Productization essentials & strategy self-assessment for enterprise software service company

A 6-hour introductory program · three 2-hour live sessions · prepared for SoftServe · July 2026

1. CONTEXT

SoftServe is expanding beyond classic service delivery toward more repeatable IP and productized, value-based offerings: a response to shifting customer expectations and a way to strengthen its competitive edge. Accelerators, frameworks, reusable assets and services are expected to compound across engagements: some maturing into standalone products, some serving as technology enablers, some becoming productized services, each with a clear value proposition, lifecycle and adoption path.

Different levels of productization carry very different economics, commitments and ways of working; the first strategic step is knowing where each initiative sits and where it should aim. This introductory program gives the team a shared map of those levels and of the key product-management concepts behind them, applied to SoftServe's own initiatives.

2. GOAL OF THE PROGRAM

Participants of the program are about 15 SoftServe's service leaders, capability managers, architects, technical / product owners, delivery and engineering leaders. This compact, 6-hour introduction helps them:

- understand the boundaries between the levels of productized offerings and offers, and the economics and commitment of each level;
- find the right spot on the productization ladder for SoftServe's current productization aspirations;
- navigate the key product-management concepts behind productization: define, validate, measure, manage;
- self-assess the status quo of the initiatives and potential products in flight;
- define next steps: for the productization strategy, and for the team's competence building.

3. HOW SESSIONS WORK

All sessions are 2 hours, live online, in two complementary formats. No home assignments: all work happens inside the sessions, on SoftServe's own examples; sessions conclude with the next steps to be taken by the team to upskill and to implement their productization strategy.

- **Workshop:** the framework is presented, then applied to SoftServe's pre-prepared list of initiatives and potential products.
- **Lecture with active Q&A:** a framework, a customer-adjacent worked example, then a constrained group exercise on a real SoftServe example; each session closes with a group reflection on next steps and further reading suggested by the instructor.

4. THE PROGRAM

The program below is preliminary and will be adjusted to SoftServe's context after the discovery session and the preparation input are processed.

Session	Topics	Format
1. Products in an enterprise services company 2 h · workshop	– <u>The productization ladder</u>: packaged services → technology-enabled services (accelerators) → productized services → products → products-as-a-service; the economics and commitment of each level – <u>Product strategy in a services company</u>: where to play; the product-vs-feature decision (standalone offering vs. add-on to existing delivery) – <u>Productization case studies from B2B services</u>: what worked, what stalled, and why – <u>Strategic alignment</u>: aligning business goals, product goals and initiatives (impact mapping, OKRs)	Workshop. Working with the pre-prepared list of initiatives / potential products: placing each on the productization ladder, answering the key strategic questions together, aligning with business objectives and target levels.
2. Product lifecycle overview: Define 2 h · lecture + active Q&A	– <u>Define the product idea</u>: the Product Map (the instructor's adaptation of the Lean canvas) – <u>Define the market</u>: sizing (TAM / SAM / SOM), ideal customer profile, segmentation (core / situational / non-customers; early adopters) – <u>Define the problem</u>: what the customer is trying to achieve, why, and why they can't today; why it is critical – <u>Define GTM approach</u>: distribution channels, channels' pipelines, acquisition growth strategies – <u>Discover & validate</u>: customer-discovery methods (in-depth interviews, qualitative & quantitative methods) and data analysis (product analytics, market research, segmentation)	Lecture with active Q&A. Frameworks shown on a customer-adjacent example, then a constrained exercise on a real SoftServe example; closes with a group reflection on next steps and further reading.
3. Product lifecycle overview: Measure & manage 2 h · lecture + active Q&A	– <u>Thinking in hypotheses</u>: desirability / viability / feasibility / usability risks – <u>Processing qualitative customer feedback</u> (content-analysis matrix; AI-assisted classification) – <u>The product feedback loop & measurement</u>: measuring activation, retention & engagement	Lecture with active Q&A. Same format as Session 2. The closing reflection widens to the whole program: initiative status + next steps in productization strategy and competence building.

5. INSTRUCTOR

Alex Orlov: seasoned B2B technology product leader with 14 years of experience in enterprise B2B SaaS, product innovation and expansion, and agentic AI.

- former SVP of Product at Creatio (enterprise B2B SaaS platform), former Chief Product Officer, Innovations at Jooble, currently Chief Product Officer at GigaCloud (cloud infrastructure) and fractional product leader, and advisor.
- Currently advising SoftServe's R&D unit on repeatable-IP strategy and productization processes.
- Product-management lecturer and corporate-program author for practicing product teams and technical leaders.

6. WHAT'S INCLUDED

The introductory program includes:

- adaptation of the program and materials to SoftServe's context (session decks + exercise templates);
- delivery of the three live sessions;
- access to all materials together with video recordings of every session;
- a curated further-reading list for each topic.

7. NEXT STEPS

To make the sessions work on real material, two steps precede the program:

1. **Preparation.** The team compiles the list of products, services and initiatives in work or under consideration: the working material for the Session-I workshop and the exercises.
2. **Discovery session.** A short session with the program sponsor(s) to align expectations, participants and emphasis, and pick the working examples.

With best regards,

Alex Orlov